

visibility in fog. Infrared equipment is used by the police and military as well as in fire fighting to enhance visibility. They are used in spectrometers used to test and study electronic systems.

Infrared imaging is used by satellites to monitor the weather, vegetation patterns, ocean temperatures and several other applications in astronomy.

Inkjet Printer

There is no clear inventor as such of the inkjet printer although rumours point to an IBM technician named Steven Sears. It was invented in 1978, and in 1988 Hewlett Packard released the Deskjet Printer as a home consumer item for a whopping price of \$1000.

An inkjet printer places small droplets of ink onto paper to create an image, and its advantage was that it sprayed ink only when necessary and so, overall, was not very expensive.

The early inkjet printers focussed only on affordability, not quality, and so were able to print low quality black and white documents fairly quickly.

Printer developers still faced problems with the printer, namely because the flow of ink from the print head to the page needed to be controlled and because, at the time, dried ink would clog the printer head. IBM devised a strategy of using electrically charged droplets for coating the pages with ink but this failed due to a variety of reasons. It was here that Hewlett-Packard and Canon built on the idea of an inkjet printer by introducing liquid ink held in cartridges and just like that, a more efficient and consumer-friendly system was born.

If you are used to hitting your printer because it's not working like you want it to, think of the long journey it has travelled to be sitting on

